

Absolutely — **that** is an excellent choice because it is not mainly a case of ordinary lexical polysemy. It is a **high-value grammatical/polyfunctionality word**: the same spelling functions as a **demonstrative determiner, demonstrative pronoun, relative pronoun, conjunction/complementizer, and degree adverb**.

Your passage itself contains several of these functions, so this is exactly the kind of word the scanning SOP says should be labelled honestly as a grammar/polyfunctionality target rather than forced into ordinary dictionary-style polysemy.

Word family: **that**

Base word: that

Plural demonstrative counterpart: those

Related demonstratives: this, these, those

Part of speech / function: demonstrative determiner (指示限定詞) / demonstrative pronoun (指示代名詞) / relative pronoun (關係代名詞) / conjunction-complementizer (連接詞 / 補語標記) / adverb (程度副詞)

That does not have a normal derivational family like *organise → organisation → organiser*. Its richness is primarily **grammatical**, so I would not invent derivatives.

Your passage contains several different uses

A. Relative **that**

> “a pair of glasses **that** made him look serious” at first sight”

Here **that** introduces a relative clause describing **glasses**.

B. Complement-clause **that**

> “The reason I remember him so well is **that** he changed the way I thought about learning.”

> “He showed me **that** a good question could open a door”, and **that** one event could be understood from different angles.”

Here **that** introduces a clause expressing information/content.

C. Demonstrative pronoun **that**

> “**That** made his lessons feel alive.”

> “**That** is why he has stayed in my memory...”

Here **that** stands by itself and refers back to an idea or situation.

D. Demonstrative determiner **that**

> “and **that balance** is not easy to find.”

Here **that** points to a specific balance already mentioned:

> firm but fair.

So your passage alone already demonstrates **four major functions**.

1. **that + noun** (指向較遠 / 已提及事物) — 那個 ; 那種 ; 那項

Here **that** is a **demonstrative determiner**.

It comes directly before a noun.

Practice 1

> “I still remember **that lesson**.”

「我仍然記得**那堂課**。」

Practice 2

> “**That teacher** changed the way I thought about history.”

「**那位老師**改變了我思考歷史的方式。」

that + noun = 指向特定、通常較遠或前文已經提到的人 / 事物

It can indicate:

- * physical distance;
- * time distance;
- * discourse distance;
- * something already mentioned.

2. **that + noun** (回指前文概念) — 剛才所說的那個 / 那種

This is your passage use:

> “He was firm, but fair, and **that balance** is not easy to find.”

Practice 3 — Original

> “He was firm, but fair, and **that balance** is not easy to find.”

「他很有原則，但同時也很公道，而**那種平衡**並不容易找到。」

Practice 4

> “She was strict but supportive, and **that combination** worked well.”

「她既嚴格又支持學生，而**那種組合**很有效。」

Practice 5

> “He encouraged questions, and **that attitude** made students more confident.”

「他鼓勵學生提問，而**那種態度**令學生更有信心。」

that + noun = 指向前文已描述的某個具體概念 / 特質

This belongs to the same demonstrative-determiner sense as #1, so we should not pretend it is a separate lexical meaning.

3. **that** = demonstrative pronoun (代替一件事 / 一個概念) — 那個；那件事；那一點

Here **that** stands alone without a following noun.

Your passage:

> “**That** made his lessons feel alive.”

The word **that** refers back to:

> the teacher asking students *why* rather than simply giving them the answer.

Practice 6 — Original

> “**That** made his lessons feel alive.”

「**那一點 / 那種做法**令他的課堂變得很有生命力。」

Practice 7

> “He listened carefully to every answer. **That** impressed me.”

「他仔細聽每一個答案。**這一點 / 那件事**令我印象深刻。」

Practice 8

> “She never embarrassed weaker students. **That** mattered to them.”

「她從不令能力較弱的學生難堪。**這一點**對他們很重要。」

that — pronoun = 代替前文已提及的一件事、情況、觀點或行為

4. **That is why + result (前述原因 → 結果)** — 這就是為甚麼.....

Another source use:

> “**That is why** he has stayed in my memory for so many years...”

Practice 9 — Original

> “**That is why** he has stayed in my memory for so many years.”

「**這就是為甚麼**過了這麼多年，我仍然記得他。」

Practice 10

> “He treated every student with respect. **That is why** they trusted him.”

「他尊重每一位學生。**這就是為甚麼**他們信任他。」

that is why = 前文所述情況就是後面結果的原因

This is a very useful fixed discourse construction, but it grows from demonstrative **that**, not a separate lexical meaning.

5. **that + relative clause (關係代名詞)** —的；用來修飾前面的名詞

Your passage:

> “a pair of glasses **that made him look serious** at first sight”

Here:

* antecedent = **glasses**

* relative clause = **that made him look serious**

Practice 11 — Original

> “He wore a pair of glasses **that made him look serious**.”

「他戴著一副**令他看起來很嚴肅的**眼鏡。」

Practice 12

> “She asked a question **that changed the discussion**.”

「她問了一條**改變了整場討論的**問題。」

Practice 13

> “We studied an event **that influenced the whole country**.”

「我們研究了一件**影響整個國家的**事件。」

****relative that = 引出限定性關係子句，提供辨認 / 界定前面名詞所需的資料****

Here ****that**** roughly corresponds to:

> who / which

depending on the antecedent.

6. ****relative that + person (人物) — who 的替代形式****

****That**** can refer to people in defining relative clauses.

Practice 14

> “The teacher ****that inspired me most**** taught history.”

「****最啟發我的那位老師****教歷史。」

Practice 15

> “Students **that ask questions** often understand the topic more deeply.”

「**會主動提問的學生**往往對題目理解得更深入。」

that — relative person = 在限定性關係子句中指前面的某個人 / 某類人

However, **who** is often preferred for people:

> “the teacher **who inspired me**”

very natural.

7. **relative that + thing (事物)** — **which** 的替代形式

Practice 16

> “The book **that he recommended** was excellent.”

「他推薦的**那本書**非常好。」

Practice 17

> “The method **that we used** was simple.”

「我們使用的**方法**很簡單。」

that — relative thing = 在限定性關係子句中指前面的事物

8. **object relative that can be omitted (作受詞時可省略)**

A very important grammar point.

Compare:

> “The book **that I read** was interesting.”

and:

> “The book **I read** was interesting.”

Both are correct.

Practice 18

> “The question **that he asked** was difficult.”

=

> “The question **he asked** was difficult.”

「他問的那條問題很難。」

Practice 19

> “The lesson **that I remember best** was about the Cold War.”

=

> “The lesson **I remember best** was about the Cold War.”

「我記得最清楚的那堂課是關於冷戰的。」

When relative **that** is the **object** of the relative clause, it can often be omitted.

9. **subject relative that cannot normally be omitted**

Your passage gives us exactly this:

> “glasses **that made him look serious**”

Here **that** is the subject of **made**.

You cannot normally say:

> “glasses made him look serious”

if you mean the relative-clause structure.

Practice 20

> “The question **that changed my mind** was very simple.”

「**改變我想法的那條問題**很簡單。」

Practice 21

> “The teacher **that taught us history** was excellent.”

「**教我們歷史的那位老師**很出色。」

subject relative that = 本身就是關係子句的主語，因此通常不能省略

10. **that + clause after verb** (補語子句) — 引出「所想 / 所知 / 所說」的內容

This is a major source use.

> “He showed me **that a good question could open a door**.”

Here **that** does not mean 「那個」.

It introduces the **content** of what he showed the speaker.

Practice 22 — Original

> “He showed me **that a good question could open a door**.”

「他讓我明白，**一個好的問題可以打開一道門**。」

Practice 23

> “I believe **that good teachers encourage curiosity**.”

「我相信**好老師會鼓勵好奇心**。」

Practice 24

> “She explained **that there were several possible answers**.”

「她解釋說，**有幾個可能的答案**。」

that + clause = 引出思想、說話、知識、理解等內容的子句

Common verbs:

- * think that
- * believe that
- * know that
- * say that
- * show that
- * explain that

* realise that

11. **that + clause after be (表語補語) —就是..... ; 事實 / 原因是.....**

Your passage:

> “The reason I remember him so well is **that he changed the way I thought about learning**.”

Practice 25 — Original

> “The reason I remember him so well is **that he changed the way I thought about learning**.”

「我之所以對他印象這麼深刻，是**因為他改變了我對學習的看法**。」

Practice 26

> “The problem is **that we have very little time**.”

「問題是**我們時間很少**。」

be + that-clause = 用完整子句說明前面的原因、問題、事實、重點等具體內容

Common:

* the reason is that...

* the problem is that...

* the truth is that...

* the fact is that...

12. **that + clause after noun (名詞內容) — 引出某個事實 / 想法的具體內容**

Practice 27

> “The fact **that he remembered every student’s name** impressed me.”

「**他記得每位學生名字這個事實**令我印象深刻。」

Practice 28

> “There is a possibility **that the lesson will be cancelled**.”

「有一種可能性，**就是那堂課會被取消**。」

****noun + that-clause = 用子句具體說明某個 fact, idea, possibility, belief 等的內容****

This is called a ****content clause****, not a relative clause.

That distinction is important.

Critical distinction: ****relative that vs content-clause that****

Compare:

Relative clause

> “The idea ****that changed my mind**** was simple.”

Here ****that**** performs a grammatical role inside the clause:

> that = subject of changed

「改變我想法的那個構思」

Content clause

> “The idea ****that learning should involve thinking**** changed my mind.”

Here ****that**** merely introduces the content of ****idea****:

> learning should involve thinking

「學習應該包含思考這個想法」

This is a very high-value distinction.

13. ****complement that can often be omitted (口語中常省略) ****

After many verbs:

> “I think ****that**** he is right.”

and:

> “I think he is right.”

Both are natural.

Practice 29

> “I believe **that** he was a great teacher.”

=

> “I believe he was a great teacher.”

「我相信他是一位很出色的老師。」

Practice 30

> “She said **that**the exam was difficult.”

=

> “She said the exam was difficult.”

「她說考試很難。」

complementizer that = 在很多動詞後可省略，尤其口語和非正式文字中

But omission is not equally natural everywhere.

14. **that** after adjective (形容詞補語) — 引出情緒 / 評價的原因或內容

Practice 31

> “I’m glad **that**you enjoyed the lesson.”

「我很高興**你**喜歡那堂課。」

Practice 32

> “She was surprised **that**everyone remembered him.”

「她很驚訝**大家都**記得他。」

adjective + that-clause = 引出某種情感、評價或狀態所針對的具體事情

Common:

* glad that
* happy that
* surprised that
* worried that
* certain that
* aware that

15. **so + adjective/adverb + that + result (結果子句) —得以致.....**

You already curated **so**, but **that** has a clear grammatical role here.

Practice 33

> “The explanation was **so clear that everyone understood it**.”

「解釋**清楚得所有人都明白了**。」

Practice 34

> “He spoke **so quietly that I could hardly hear him**.”

「他說話**小聲得我幾乎聽不到**。」

that = 引出前面程度所造成的結果

Structure:

> **so + adjective/adverb + that + result**

This is not demonstrative **that**.

16. **such + noun + that + result (結果子句) — 如此.....以致.....**

Practice 35

> “He was **such a good teacher that** students remembered him for years.”

「他是一位**好得令學生多年後仍記得他的老師**。」

Practice 36

> “It was **such an interesting lesson that** nobody wanted it to end.”

「那堂課**有趣得沒有人想它結束**。」

Again:

that = 引出結果子句

17. **that + adjective/adverb (程度)** — 那麼 ; 這麼

Here **that** is an **adverb**, especially common in negatives and questions.

Practice 37

> “The exam wasn’t **that difficult**.”

「考試沒有**那麼難**。」

Practice 38

> “I didn’t realise the school was **that far away**.”

「我沒想到學校竟然**那麼遠**。」

that + adjective/adverb = 達到前文 / 情境所暗示的那種程度 ; 那麼 / 這麼

Very common:

- * not that bad
- * not that hard
- * that much
- * that far
- * that long

18. **that much / that many (程度 / 數量)** — 那麼多 ; 那種程度

Practice 39

> “I didn’t expect to learn **that much**.”

「我沒想到會學到**那麼多**。」

Practice 40

> “Were there really **that many students**?”

「真的有**那麼多學生**嗎？」

that much/many = 指前文、眼前或已假定的數量 / 程度

19. **that of / those of** (正式比較替代) —的那個 / 那些

A very useful formal construction.

Practice 41

> “His teaching style was different from **that of** other teachers.”

「他的教學風格與其他老師**的教學風格**不同。」

Practice 42

> “The results of this class were better than **those of** the other classes.”

「這個班的成績比其他班**的成績**好。」

Here:

> **that** replaces a singular noun

> **those** replaces a plural noun

This prevents unnecessary repetition.

that of = 用 that 代替前文單數名詞，以便正式比較

20. **What is that? / Who is that?** (指示代名詞) — 那是甚麼 / 那是誰

A common direct demonstrative use.

Practice 43

> “What is **that** on the board?”

「黑板上的**那個**是甚麼？」

Practice 44

> “Who is **that** standing by the door?”

「站在門旁的**那個人**是誰？」

that = 指向較遠、眼前可辨認的人 / 物

Important distinction: **this** vs **that**

this

usually indicates something:

- * physically nearer;
- * temporally nearer;
- * currently being introduced.

that

often indicates:

- * physically farther;
- * earlier-mentioned;
- * psychologically/discoursally more distant.

Compare:

> “This book here is mine.”

「這本書是我的。」

> “That book over there is yours.”

「那邊那本書是你的。」

But discourse usage is flexible.

Important distinction: **that** vs **it**

that

often actively points back to a whole idea/event.

> “He encouraged us to question facts. **That** changed me.”

it

often refers to an already established noun/thing more neutrally.

> “I bought the book. **It** was expensive.”

So:

that often has stronger pointing/emphasis.

Important distinction: **that** vs **what**

This is crucial.

that

usually needs an antecedent or introduces a content clause.

> “I know **that** he is right.”

what

means roughly:

> **the thing that**

> “I know **what** he wants.”

= 我知道**他想要甚麼 / 他所想要的東西**。

Not:

> “I know that he wants.” 

unless a complete clause follows.

Important distinction: **relative that** vs **who**

For people:

> “the teacher **who** inspired me”

and:

> “the teacher **that** inspired me”

Both are possible in defining relative clauses.

who

often preferred for people.

that

very common, especially in restrictive/defining clauses.

Important distinction: **relative that vs which**

For things:

> “the book **that** I read”

> “the book **which** I read”

Both can be possible in defining clauses.

But in non-defining clauses with commas:

> “The book, **which** I bought yesterday, is excellent.” 

Normally not:

> “The book, **that** I bought yesterday, is excellent.” 

That is normally not used in non-defining relative clauses.

Excellent grammar point.

Important distinction: **that** cannot normally follow a preposition directly in formal relative

clauses**

Natural:

> “The topic **that we talked about**...”

Formal:

> “The topic **about which we talked**...”

Normally not:

> **“the topic about that we talked”*



So when a preposition is placed before the relative pronoun, use:

* whom

* which

not **that**.

Important distinction: **that vs those**

that

singular:

> that student

those

plural:

> those students

Also in substitution:

> “The result was better than **that** of the other class.”

> “The results were better than **those** of the other classes.”

Important distinction: **that-clause vs relative clause**

One of the most important lessons in this family:

Content/complement:

> “I believe **that** he is right.”

that merely introduces a complete clause.

Relative:

> “The student **that** answered was right.”

that represents **the student** inside the clause.

Diagnostic:

In a content clause:

> “he is right”

is already grammatically complete.

In:

> “that answered”

the relative word fills the missing subject role.

Important omission rules

Complement-clause **that**

often optional:

> “I think (that) he is right.”

Object relative **that**

often optional:

> “the book (that) I read”

Subject relative **that**

not normally optional:

> “the book that changed my life”

not:

> * “the book changed my life” *

when a relative construction is intended.

These three patterns are extremely useful for learners.

Family-extension sweep

That has essentially no meaningful derivational family. Its learning value comes from grammatical functions:

- * **that + noun** = 那個 / 那種
- * **that — demonstrative pronoun** = 那件事 / 那一點
- * **that is why** = 這就是為甚麼
- * **relative that — person/thing** = 引出限定性關係子句
- * **object relative that** = 常可省略
- * **subject relative that** = 通常不能省略
- * **verb + that-clause** = 引出思想 / 說話 / 認知內容
- * **be + that-clause** = 說明原因、問題、事實等內容
- * **noun + that-clause** = 說明某個名詞所代表的具體內容
- * **adjective + that-clause** = 引出情感 / 評價所針對的事情
- * **so...that** = 引出結果
- * **such...that** = 引出結果
- * **that + adjective/adverb** = 那麼 / 這麼
- * **that much/many** = 那麼多
- * **that of / those of** = 正式比較中的名詞替代

Under the Golden Manual, this is exactly the kind of word where **polyfunctionality**, not morphology, is the main teaching value. The SOP specifically identifies **that** as a grammar-function candidate.

Master comparison

Form / function	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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that + noun	指向特定、通常較遠或前文已提及的人 / 事物；那個 / 那種	
that — demonstrative pronoun	代替前文已提及的一件事、情況、觀點或行為	
that is why	指出前文所述情況正是後面結果的原因	
relative that	引出限定性關係子句，並代表前面的人 / 物在子句中的角色	
object relative that	在關係子句中作受詞，因此通常可以省略	
subject relative that	在關係子句中作主語，因此通常不能省略	
verb + that-clause	引出思想、說話、認知、理解等內容的完整子句	
be + that-clause	用完整子句說明前面的原因、問題、事實或重點	
noun + that-clause	用完整子句具體說明 fact、idea、possibility 等名詞的內容	
adjective + that-clause	引出情緒、評價或狀態所針對的具體事情	
so...that	引出前面某種程度所造成的結果	
such...that	引出前面某種人物 / 事物特質所造成的結果	
that + adjective/adverb	表示達到前文或情境所暗示的程度；那麼 / 這麼	
that much/many	指前文、眼前或假定的那麼大的數量 / 程度	
that of / those of	用指示代名詞替代前文名詞，避免正式比較中重複	

For your passage

Your passage contains ****four major functions**** of ****that****:

1. Relative pronoun

> “glasses ****that made him look serious****”

****that** = 引出修飾 glasses 的限定性關係子句

2. Complementizer

> “The reason ... is ****that he changed the way I thought about learning****.”

> “He showed me ****that a good question could open a door****...”

****that** = 引出完整內容子句，本身不等於「那個」

3. Demonstrative pronoun

> “****That**** made his lessons feel alive.”

> “****That**** is why...”

****that** = 指回前文整件事情 / 做法

4. Demonstrative determiner

> “****that balance**** is not easy to find”

****that = 指前文所說「firm but fair」的那種平衡****

So ****that**** is one of the clearest examples in this passage of why our scanning SOP separates ****lexical polysemy**** from ****grammatical multifunctionality****. It is not one ordinary vocabulary word with fifteen unrelated dictionary meanings; it is one extremely versatile grammatical form performing several very different jobs.